AI SYNERGY HACKATHON 2026 · CASE 01 · ROUND 1

The Last-Mile AI Gap

From unclear rules and uneven access to AI readiness that students can actually show

Project: AI Sathi · Team [team name]

What the case tells us

31%

use generative AI daily. 37% use it sometimes and 32% rarely or never.

46%

have reliable laptop access, even though 78% own a smartphone.

42%

explain complex ideas more easily in Hindi or mixed Hindi-English.

Rules differ by department

Some faculty encourage AI with disclosure, others ban it. Students are unsure what is allowed.

Polish is not understanding

Faculty report that AI-assisted work does not always match what the student understands.

Source: case evidence pack (simulated survey, n = 600)

FINAL PROBLEM STATEMENT

Students on low-end devices, and those who think in Hindi or Hinglish, cannot tell what AI use is allowed or show what they truly understand. Rules differ by department and assessments reward polished output, so the gap in confidence and real learning grows.

Why this framing: it sits upstream of the access, language and literacy symptoms, and it can be measured with task evidence rather than usage counts.

Framings compared: access · literacy · confidence · assessment design · policy ambiguity · language

AI Sathi: what we will build

1. Clear rules

A green, amber or red AI-use label on every assignment, written in English and Hindi.

2. Optional coach

A text-first helper in Hindi, Hinglish and English that runs in a phone browser on limited data.

3. Explain-your-work

A short task where students explain their reasoning. Faculty score it against a rubric.

4. Fairness view

Combined results by device tier and language. No reading of private conversations.

How it works, step by step

1	**Faculty set the rule**	Pick a green, amber or red AI-use level for each task and approve the Hindi and English wording.
2	**Students see it first**	The rule shows on the phone before they start, and they choose whether to use the optional coach.
3	**Students submit and explain**	They hand in the work with a short explanation of their reasoning, in the language they prefer.
4	**Faculty score understanding**	AI suggests rubric points from the submitted work. The faculty member makes the final call.
5	**Administrators review**	Combined results show clarity, learning and fairness gaps by device tier and language.

Who does what: AI and humans

AI supports

- Translates and simplifies rule labels into Hindi and Hinglish, for faculty approval
- Offers optional study help in the student's language
- Drafts explain-your-work prompts and suggests rubric points
- Summarises combined patterns for administrators

Humans decide

- Faculty set the AI-use level for each task
- Faculty judge understanding and own every grade
- Students choose whether to use AI and say how they used it
- Administrators own policy and review fairness data

Guardrails: no reading of private conversations · capability claims only from task evidence · more AI use is never scored as better

Feasibility: small enough to pilot

Area	How we make it work	Still to confirm
Devices and data	Text-first web app in the phone browser, with no install and light pages	Real data limits on student plans
Language	Hindi, Hinglish and English in the interface and the coach	Whether it improves learning
Faculty effort	One AI-use label and one rubric per task, from a template	Faculty willingness
Scope	Pilot in one or two departments before scaling	Which departments

Risks and limitations

Risk or limitation	How we handle it
Extra work for faculty	One label and one rubric per task, reused from a template
Explain-your-work feels like surveillance	Only work students submit is used. No private chats are read.
Errors in Hindi or Hinglish output	Faculty approve rule text, and students test it before the pilot
Students with fewer tools penalised	AI stays optional, we score understanding not polish, and we track the gap by device tier
Evidence is a simulated survey	Why non-users avoid AI is unconfirmed, so we validate with a short poll

What we will build in Round 2

Working prototype

- Student flow on a phone: rule label, optional coach, explain-your-work
- Faculty view: set the AI-use level and score with a rubric
- Fairness view using sample data

Quick validation

- Short student poll on why non-users avoid AI
- Two or three faculty conversations
- Test on a low-end phone with a slow connection

We will measure: clarity of rules, understanding shown in explain-your-work tasks, and the fairness gap by device tier. We will not measure how much AI students use.